The Logo Guide

Twenty-two certification marks: who runs each, what it verifies, and — the useful line — what it does not.

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02

REFERENCE · 22 MARKS

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PART ONE

Six checks for any logo

A logo is a claim like any other. These six checks work on every mark in this guide and on every mark that is not in it.

01 Find the name

A certification names itself. A leaf, a globe, a ticked circle or the words “eco approved” with no scheme behind them is the brand’s own artwork, and tells you what the brand thinks of itself.

02 Find the number

Many schemes issue a licence or certificate number and ask for it to be printed beside the mark. A missing number is not proof of anything — some schemes do not use them — but where there is one, it is the fastest thing on the pack to check.

03 Look it up at the source

Most schemes publish a searchable list of who they certify. Search the brand there, not on the brand’s own website. If the scheme keeps a register and the brand is not in it, ask the scheme — that is what it is there for.

04 Read what it covers

Each entry in this guide gives what the scheme verifies and, separately, what it does not. The second line is the useful one. Almost every mark is narrower than the feeling it gives off.

05 Check what the mark is attached to

One certified ingredient is not a certified product, and one certified product is not a certified brand. Read the small print next to the logo for what, exactly, it is being claimed for.

06 Notice what is missing

No single mark answers every question; each answers one. A mark about animals says nothing about wages, and a mark about fibres says nothing about the factory. What a pack does not carry is information too.

PART TWO

22 marks, and what each covers

For each scheme: who runs it, what it verifies, and what it does not. Almost every one is narrower than the feeling it gives off.

CLIMATE & ENERGY

RSPO

RUN BY ROUNDTABLE ON SUSTAINABLE PALM OIL

VERIFIES	Palm oil produced to RSPO criteria on a certified plantation. 'Segregated' and 'Identity Preserved' are the strongest supply-chain models.
DOES NOT	**Weaker models ('Mass Balance', 'Book & Claim'/credits) mean certified and non-certified oil may be mixed. RSPO has faced criticism over deforestation in member supply chains.**
SOURCE	RSPO Principles & Criteria; Greenpeace critique.

FSC

RUN BY FOREST STEWARDSHIP COUNCIL

VERIFIES	Wood, paper, or forest-derived material comes from responsibly managed forests meeting FSC environmental and social standards, tracked by chain-of-custody.
DOES NOT	**'FSC Mix' blends certified, recycled, and 'controlled' material — not 100% certified. Look for 'FSC 100%' for the strongest claim.**
SOURCE	Forest Stewardship Council standards.

Rainforest Alliance

RUN BY RAINFOREST ALLIANCE

VERIFIES	Farms (coffee, cocoa, tea, bananas) met standards on forests, climate, human rights, and livelihoods, audited against the 2020 Sustainable Agriculture Standard.
DOES NOT	**Uses mass-balance for cocoa (certified and non-certified can be mixed) and has faced scrutiny over on-the-ground enforcement.**
SOURCE	Rainforest Alliance 2020 Standard.

ANIMALS

Leaping Bunny

RUN BY CRUELTY FREE INTERNATIONAL

VERIFIES	No animal testing at any stage — finished product AND ingredients — by the brand, its suppliers, or third parties, with a fixed cut-off date and independent audits plus supplier monitoring.
DOES NOT	**Does NOT mean vegan. A Leaping Bunny product can still contain animal-derived ingredients (beeswax, lanolin, carmine).**
SOURCE	Cruelty Free International / Leaping Bunny Programme.

PETA — Beauty Without Bunnies

RUN BY PETA

VERIFIES	Brand has signed a statement of assurance that it and its suppliers do not test on animals. Two logos exist: 'Animal Test-Free' and 'Animal Test-Free & Vegan'.
DOES NOT	**The standard base logo relies on a signed pledge rather than independent audit, and the test-free-only logo does not mean vegan.**
SOURCE	PETA Beauty Without Bunnies programme.

Certified Vegan (Vegan Society / Vegan Action)

RUN BY THE VEGAN SOCIETY (UK) / VEGAN ACTION (US)

VERIFIES	No animal-derived ingredients and no animal testing by the company. The sunflower trademark requires an application and ingredient review.
DOES NOT	**'Vegan' alone (uncertified) is unregulated. Vegan does not automatically mean cruelty-free unless the certifier also covers testing.**
SOURCE	The Vegan Society Trademark standards.

RSPCA Assured

RUN BY RSPCA (UK)

VERIFIES	Farm-animal welfare against RSPCA species-specific standards, covering the animal's life, transport, and slaughter, with assessment visits.
DOES NOT	**It is a welfare scheme, not organic or free-range by default, and does not mean the animal was not killed.**
SOURCE	RSPCA Assured scheme standards.

Certified Humane

RUN BY HUMANE FARM ANIMAL CARE

VERIFIES	Farm-animal welfare standards including space, no cages for hens, and no routine antibiotics, with annual third-party inspection.
DOES NOT	**A welfare label, not a 'no-slaughter' label; standards differ from organic and from country-specific free-range definitions.**
SOURCE	Humane Farm Animal Care standards.

Responsible Down / Wool Standard (RDS / RWS)

RUN BY TEXTILE EXCHANGE

VERIFIES	Down or wool traced through the supply chain with animal-welfare criteria — RDS prohibits live-plucking and force-feeding; RWS addresses sheep welfare and land management.
DOES NOT	**It improves welfare within animal use; it does not mean no animal was farmed or slaughtered. Mulesing is prohibited under RWS but check the specific claim.**
SOURCE	Textile Exchange RDS / RWS standards.

ZQ Merino

RUN BY THE NEW ZEALAND MERINO COMPANY

VERIFIES	Wool standard covering animal welfare (including non-mulesing), environmental management, and social responsibility on accredited farms.
DOES NOT	**Applies to the certified wool fibre, not the finished garment's full supply chain (dyeing, sewing, labour elsewhere).**
SOURCE	ZQ / NZ Merino.

LABOUR & SOCIAL

GOTS

RUN BY GLOBAL ORGANIC TEXTILE STANDARD

VERIFIES	Textiles with a minimum 70% certified organic fibre PLUS environmental and social criteria (banned toxic inputs, wastewater treatment, workers' rights) across the whole supply chain.
DOES NOT	**'Made with organic' (70–94%) is a lower grade than the 'organic' grade (95%+). Organic cotton still uses significant water.**
SOURCE	Global Organic Textile Standard v7.0.

OEKO-TEX Standard 100

RUN BY OEKO-TEX ASSOCIATION

VERIFIES	That the finished textile has been tested for a list of harmful substances and is below defined limits — a chemical-safety label for the end product.
DOES NOT	**It is NOT an organic, animal-welfare, labour, or environmental-footprint standard. It only addresses substances in the tested article.**
SOURCE	OEKO-TEX Standard 100 test criteria.

Fairtrade

RUN BY FAIRTRADE INTERNATIONAL

VERIFIES	Producers received the Fairtrade Minimum Price and a Fairtrade Premium, with standards on labour rights and environmental practice, independently audited by FLOCERT.
DOES NOT	**Covers the certified ingredient(s), not necessarily the whole product; on composite products a percentage applies. Not an organic or animal-welfare label.**
SOURCE	Fairtrade International Standards / FLOCERT.

B Corp

RUN BY B LAB

VERIFIES	The whole COMPANY passed a verified assessment of its social and environmental performance, accountability, and transparency (minimum score 80), re-certified every three years.
DOES NOT	**It rates the company overall — not any single product, and not specifically animal welfare or veganism. A B Corp can still sell products you might avoid.**
SOURCE	B Lab / B Impact Assessment.

Fair Wear Foundation

RUN BY FAIR WEAR FOUNDATION

VERIFIES	That a clothing brand is a member working to improve labour conditions in its supply chain, assessed on its practices (a 'Brand Performance Check').
DOES NOT	**It rates the brand's EFFORT and management, not a pass/fail guarantee that every factory is perfect. Not an environmental or animal label.**
SOURCE	Fair Wear Foundation Code of Labour Practices.

Fair Trade Certified (US)

RUN BY FAIR TRADE USA

VERIFIES	Sets standards for wages, safe conditions, and community funds for producers; distinct from Fairtrade International (different standards and governance).
DOES NOT	**Does NOT certify the whole company — only specific certified products or facilities; the rest of the brand may be unaudited.**
SOURCE	Fair Trade USA.

FOOD

Soil Association Organic

RUN BY SOIL ASSOCIATION (UK)

VERIFIES	Organic certification for food, and a separate strict standard for organic health & beauty covering ingredients, GM-free, and (for beauty) no animal testing.
DOES NOT	**Organic addresses how something is grown/made, not animal-welfare outcomes or whether an animal was killed.**
SOURCE	Soil Association Organic Standards.

USDA Organic / EU Organic Leaf

RUN BY USDA (US) / EU COMMISSION

VERIFIES	Food produced under legally-defined organic rules: no synthetic pesticides/fertilisers, no GMOs, and defined animal-welfare and feed rules for livestock.
DOES NOT	**Organic is not automatically 'free-range' nor a guarantee of high welfare beyond the baseline rules; it is not a cruelty-free or vegan label.**
SOURCE	USDA NOP / EU Reg 2018/848.

Global Recycled Standard (GRS)

RUN BY TEXTILE EXCHANGE

VERIFIES	Tracks recycled content through the supply chain (minimum 20% to carry the logo, 50%+ for full claims), plus social and environmental criteria at each stage.
DOES NOT	**Does NOT mean the whole garment is recycled, or that it is low-impact overall — only that the certified recycled content is genuine and traceable.**
SOURCE	Textile Exchange GRS.

bluesign

RUN BY BLUESIGN TECHNOLOGIES

VERIFIES	Manages chemical inputs across textile manufacturing — restricting hazardous substances and improving resource use at the factory level.
DOES NOT	**Does NOT address animal welfare or garment-worker wages; it is a chemical and environmental management system, not an ethics-of-labour mark.**
SOURCE	bluesign system.

Cradle to Cradle Certified

RUN BY CRADLE TO CRADLE PRODUCTS INNOVATION INSTITUTE

VERIFIES	Assesses products across material health, reuse, renewable energy, water, and social fairness, at Bronze–Platinum levels.
DOES NOT	**A low tier (Bronze) is a much weaker claim than Gold/Platinum — the level matters, and the logo alone doesn't tell you which.**
SOURCE	Cradle to Cradle Products Innovation Institute.

Regenerative Organic Certified (ROC)

RUN BY REGENERATIVE ORGANIC ALLIANCE

VERIFIES	Builds on organic certification with added requirements for soil health, animal welfare, and farmworker fairness — one of the stricter farm-level marks.
DOES NOT	**Still farm-level: it certifies how a raw material was grown, not how the final product was manufactured or by whom.**
SOURCE	Regenerative Organic Alliance.

PART THREE

Before you rely on a mark

Schemes revise their standards, and brands gain and lose certification.

Each entry describes a scheme's scope as set out in the source cited, at the edition date on the cover. The scheme's own website is the authority on what it requires today, and its own register is the authority on who holds it.

A mark that is absent tells you nothing by itself: certification costs money, and small producers often go without. A mark that is present tells you one thing, precisely. This guide is for knowing which thing.

LICENCE

This one is free, and meant to travel. Print it, forward it, pin it up, hand it out — unaltered, with the FERAL FEMME name on it, and never for sale. Use in teaching is welcome.

The same material is searchable and always current in the free tools at feral-femme.co/tools/. If a scheme changes its scope, the tool changes first and the next edition of this follows.

CORRECTIONS

If something here is wrong, we would rather hear it than not: info@feral-femme.co. Substantive corrections are published in full at feral-femme.co/corrections/, with what was said, what was wrong, and when it changed.

EDITION

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WHEN YOU WANT TO PUT IT TO WORK · FERAL-FEMME.CO/SHOP

The Brand Audit Workbook	PREMIUM	Audit a brand from the public record, in six modules.
The Claims Desk	PREMIUM	A claims review procedure and working file, for brands.
The Wardrobe & Bathroom Audit	PREMIUM	Four weeks, two rooms, and a list for what you buy next.
The Complaint Kit	PREMIUM	Ask, escalate and speak up, with a template for each step.